

Sunday, 16 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

26° 20°

BIRMINGHAM

Light drizzle

23° 14°

MANCHESTER

Light drizzle

20° 15°

GLASGOW

Heavy drizzle

18° 13°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Tributes are pouring in for Professor Jason Arday, the youngest black professor in the UK, who has died at the age of 38.

The Prime Minister described his death as a 'tragedy on so many levels'. Professor Arday became a Cambridge professor last year, having only learned to read and write in his late teens.

EDUCATION · UK

2

Wildfires across England and Wales have prompted a national alert, with the Prime Minister confirming 19 homes have been destroyed.

Thirty-seven fires are currently burning across the country, stretching emergency services. Military personnel are now being deployed to help tackle the blazes.

ENVIRONMENT · UK

3

After weeks of scorching temperatures, the heatwave is officially coming to an end, with a significant drop in temperatures expected this weekend.

The fifth widespread heatwave of the year will give way to noticeably cooler weather. It's a welcome relief for many after record-breaking heat.

WEATHER · UK

4

The Met Police has apologised after a data breach involving alleged victims of Dodi Al Fayed.

Scotland Yard mistakenly copied in all those who had signed up to receive monthly updates on the case. It's another blow for the force regarding data handling.

CRIME · UK

5

A temporary ban on disposable BBQs has been implemented as military personnel are deployed to help battle wildfires.

The government warns that single-use grills pose a 'significant risk to the public' in current drought and heatwave conditions. It's hoped the ban will prevent further fires.

SAFETY · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Big news for superhero fans! Sadie Sink and Adam Driver are set to star in a new X-Men movie.**
They'll be joining 'Heartstopper's' Kit Connor and Christopher Abbot in the latest Marvel Cinematic Universe instalment. Expect plenty of excitement from the new cast.

ON AIR – What do you think of this casting? Who would you love to see join the X-Men universe?

FILM · COMING UP
- 2 Actress Bella Ramsey, known for 'The Last of Us', has revealed she wishes she'd been a more rebellious teenager.**
Bella is starring in a new film about a cancer survivor finding friendship and freedom at 'chemo camp'. It sounds like a powerful and moving story.

ON AIR – Did you have a rebellious phase as a teenager, or were you more well-behaved? What's your take on teenage rebellion?

FILM · COMING UP
- 3 The creator of the Netflix hit 'The Polygamist', Zimbabwean novelist Sue Nyathi, says women see themselves reflected in her show.**
Sue self-funded her debut novel, which has now found huge success on Netflix. It's a fantastic story of perseverance and talent.

ON AIR – Have you watched 'The Polygamist'? What recent TV shows have really resonated with you?

TV · NOW
- 4 A musician is going ahead with her Edinburgh Fringe shows after her treasured instruments were stolen.**
Sachie Mikawa's trumpet and vintage melodica went missing, forcing her to cancel best-selling nights. Thankfully, she's now found a way to perform.

ON AIR – What's the most important item you own that you'd be devastated to lose?

MUSIC · NOW
- 5 Glastonbury festival organiser Emily Eavis has dismissed rumours that Madonna will headline in 2027.**
Emily confirmed the festival has already booked its headliners for that year. She was clear that the Queen of Pop is 'definitely not' among them.

ON AIR – Who would be your dream headliner for Glastonbury? Any acts you'd love to see on the Pyramid Stage?

MUSIC · FUTURE

On the schedule

1 **Great Britain's women and men's 4×100m relay teams have both powered through to their respective finals.**

Amy Hunt and Zharnel Hughes were among those who ran strong qualifying heats at the European Athletics Championships in Birmingham. We'll be cheering them on for medals!

ON AIR – How do you rate GB's chances in the 4×100m relay finals? Are you feeling optimistic?

ATHLETICS · UK

2 **Paul Walter's huge hitting has propelled Manchester Super Giants into The Hundred final!**

Walter smashed 80 off 46 balls to help his team beat Sunrisers Leeds in the Eliminator. They'll now face Trent Rockets in the men's final.

ON AIR – Who are you backing to win The Hundred final? Are you a fan of the tournament?

CRICKET · UK

3 **Great Britain's Keely Hodgkinson has taken silver in the 800m at the European Athletics Championships.**

She was unable to defend her title, with Switzerland's Audrey Werro putting in a fantastic performance. Still, a brilliant silver for Keely!

ON AIR – What a performance from Keely Hodgkinson! Do you think she'll be back for gold next time?

ATHLETICS · UK

4 **British cyclist Finlay Tarling's team has withdrawn from the Volta a Portugal following his tragic death.**

His team, NSN, will not compete in the remaining stages of the race. Our thoughts are with his family, friends, and teammates.

ON AIR – It's such sad news from the world of cycling. What a terrible loss for the sport.

CYCLING · UK

5 **Scottie Scheffler has equalled the course record with a stunning nine-under 61 at the St Jude Championship.**

He now holds a three-stroke lead at the end of the second round of the first play-off event in Memphis. What a round of golf!

ON AIR – Can anyone catch Scottie Scheffler after that incredible round? Do you enjoy watching the golf play-offs?

GOLF · INTERNATIONAL

Quick hits

- 1 Gardeners are finding a renewed joy in cultivating 'forgotten' heritage vegetable varieties.**
Many are discovering unique flavours and stories behind older types of beans, carrots, and tomatoes that have been less common in modern supermarkets. It's a lovely way to connect with gardening history.
- 2 The simple pleasure of 'window box gardening' is seeing a charming resurgence in urban areas.**
Even those without large gardens are transforming their windowsills into vibrant displays of flowers and herbs. It adds a lovely splash of green to bustling streets and brings a little nature closer to home.
- 3 A delightful trend for 'vintage picnic baskets' and traditional outdoor dining is sweeping the nation.**
People are embracing the nostalgia of proper wicker baskets, checked blankets, and even proper china for their al fresco meals. It's making picnics feel a little more special and less 'grab and go'.
- 4 New research suggests that 'solving jigsaw puzzles' can significantly boost cognitive function and reduce stress.**
It seems the quiet concentration and methodical sorting involved in piecing together a puzzle provides a wonderful mental workout and a calming escape from daily worries. Perfect for a rainy afternoon!
- 5 The delightful art of 'letter writing' and sending handwritten notes is experiencing a heartwarming revival.**
In a world of instant messages, receiving a thoughtfully penned letter feels incredibly personal and special. It's a lovely way to show someone you truly care and value them.
- 6 Local libraries are becoming hubs for 'community skill-sharing workshops', beyond just books.**
From knitting circles to introductory coding classes, these spaces are fostering a wonderful sense of community and helping people learn new crafts and practical abilities from their neighbours.
- 7 The charming tradition of 'collecting decorative teacups and saucers' is making a comeback amongst home enthusiasts.**
Beyond just display, many are using these beautiful pieces for their daily brews, adding a touch of elegance and whimsy to their morning routine or afternoon cuppa.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to figure out which key on our keyring opens a particular door, even if it's the wrong key?

ANSWER: WIGGLING EVERY SINGLE KEY IN THE LOCK, JUST IN CASE!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, fresh packet of crisps. What is it?

ANSWER: SHAKING THE PACKET VIGOROUSLY, TO EVENLY DISTRIBUTE THE FLAVOURING!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you stumble upon a 'tiny, independent shop' that sells the most wonderfully niche or handmade items, and it just feels like discovering a hidden gem?

We're asking, what's the most surprising or delightful little independent shop you've ever discovered, and what made it so special?

- We all have those 'little everyday moments' that, despite their simplicity, bring us a surprising amount of joy – like catching the postman, or a perfectly brewed cup of tea.

What's a small, perhaps slightly mundane, moment in your day that consistently brings a little smile to your face, and why?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** There is a 'space-junk' satellite called 'Vanguard 1' that was launched in 1958 and is still in orbit today, making it the oldest artificial satellite still circling Earth.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A 'pet-friendly' café in London recently introduced a special 'doggy afternoon tea' menu, featuring miniature bone-shaped sandwiches and pupper-cinos, which quickly became a huge hit.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£32 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£32 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of owls is called a 'parliament'.
- The world's largest hot air balloon festival takes place every October in Albuquerque, New Mexico.
- The 'Queen's official piper' plays the bagpipes outside her window every morning when she is in residence.
- The 'Great Fire of London' in 1666, despite its devastation, helped eradicate the Black Death from the city.
- The 'hummingbird' is the only bird that can fly backwards.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The 'Post Office' in the UK has been around since 1660.
- The first ever episode of 'Doctor Who' aired on 23 November 1963.

On this day

Day 228 of the year, 137 days left in 2026. Today Bennington Battle Day (Vermont, United States); Children's Day (Paraguay); Christian feast day: Ana Petra Pérez Florido; Christian feast day: Armel (Armagillus). Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1962 — Steve Carell, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1970 — Seth Peterson, American actor
- 1963 — Christine Cavanaugh, American voice artist (died 2014)
- 1942 — Barbara George, American R&B singer-songwriter (died 2006)
- 1979 — Paul Gallacher, Scottish footballer
- 1946 — Lesley Ann Warren, American actress
- 1958 — Angela Bassett, American actress
- 1945 — Bob Balaban, American actor, director, and producer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1975 — Australian Prime Minister Gough Whitlam symbolically hands over land to the Gurindji people after the eight-year Wave Hill walk-off, a landmark event in the history of Indigenous land rights in Australia, commemorated in a 1991 song by Paul Kelly and an annual celebration.
- 1945 — The National Representatives' Congress, the precursor of the current National Assembly of Vietnam, convenes in Sơn Dương.
- 1954 — The first issue of Sports Illustrated is published.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1975 — Australian Prime Minister Gough Whitlam symbolically hands over land to the Gurindji people after the eight-year Wave Hill walk-off, a landmark event in the history of Indigenous land rights in Australia, commemorated in a 1991 song by Paul Kelly and an annual celebration.
- 2013 — The ferry St. Thomas Aquinas collides with a cargo ship and sinks at Cebu, Philippines, killing 61 people with 59 others missing.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1964 — Vietnam War: A coup d'état replaces Dương Văn Minh with General Nguyễn Khánh as President of South Vietnam. A new constitution is established with aid from the U.S. Embassy.

- 1946 — The All Hyderabad Trade Union Congress is founded in Secunderabad.
- 1945 — The National Representatives' Congress, the precursor of the current National Assembly of Vietnam, convenes in Sơn Dương.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 229 of the year, 136 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Saint Beatrice of Silva; Christian feast day: Saint Clare of Montefalco; Christian feast day: Elias of Enna; Christian feast day: Saint Hyacinth of Poland. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1943 — Dave "Snaker" Ray, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2002)
- 1967 — David Conrad, American actor
- 1968 — Helen McCrory, English actress (died 2021)
- 1988 — Joyner Lucas, American rapper
- 1953 — Kevin Rowland, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1949 — Sib Hashian, American rock drummer (died 2017)
- 1946 — Martha Coolidge, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1962 — Gilby Clarke, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1962 — Peter Fechter is shot and bleeds to death while trying to cross the new Berlin Wall.
- 1988 — President of Pakistan Muhammad Zia-ul-Haq and U.S. Ambassador Arnold Raphel are killed in a plane crash.
- 2008 — American swimmer Michael Phelps becomes the first person to win eight gold medals at one Olympic Games.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1960 — Aeroflot Flight 036 crashes in Soviet Ukraine, killing 34.
- 1988 — President of Pakistan Muhammad Zia-ul-Haq and U.S. Ambassador Arnold Raphel are killed in a plane crash.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

22–23

Belgian Grand Prix (F1)